CLASS 10 — ENGLISH · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 2

Chapter 8: **The Sermon at Benares (First Flight)** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. The sermon moves from the specific to the general by: 1

(a) describing places
(b) listing kings
(c) turning one mother's loss into a universal truth
(d) quoting laws

2. A reader sceptical of the story might argue that: 1

(a) mustard is rare
(b) such a task may not console everyone
(c) death is not real
(d) the Buddha was not wise

3. Which is closest to the moral of the story? 1

(a) Accept the inevitable and help others who grieve
(b) Do not trust villagers
(c) Never marry
(d) Avoid all houses

4. The image 'like a ripe fruit' in the sermon suggests: 1

(a) colour
(b) trade
(c) sweetness of life
(d) inevitable fall of life

5. Which pair of themes is central to the text? 1

(a) wealth and poverty
(b) love and hate
(c) power and fame
(d) impermanence and compassion

6. A suitable heading for a news report on the story is: 1

(a) Rain destroys crops
(b) Mother learns truth of life through a mustard seed
(c) Flight mystery
(d) Bus ride

7. The narrative technique of the first half is: 1

(a) storytelling with dialogue
(b) list
(c) argument
(d) description of a place

8. The word 'sermon' differs from 'lecture' because it: 1

(a) is longer
(b) carries a moral or spiritual purpose
(c) is shorter
(d) is funny

9. The ethical stance of the sermon is: 1

(a) compassion without attachment **(b)** escape from duty
(c) violence for justice **(d)** wealth for fame

10. The sermon's rhetorical device of repeating examples is: 1

(a) irony **(b)** parallelism **(c)** onomatopoeia **(d)** pun

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. Why is the story universal rather than local? 2

12. What does the sermon imply about individual and collective suffering? 2

13. Why does the Buddha's gentleness make the lesson stronger? 2

14. How does the lesson blend narrative with philosophy? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Explain the role of repetition in the villagers' replies and the sermon. 3

16. Discuss the role of language style in conveying the sermon's authority. 3

17. Write a short note on the use of contrast in the lesson. 3

OR

Discuss how the image of the potter's vessels represents mortal life. 3

18. What does the lesson suggest about the limits of human power? 3

OR

Suggest two ways the lesson might help a modern teenager. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. Critically examine whether the Buddha's teaching is practical for modern life. 5

OR

Write a letter from Kisa Gotami to her sister describing her changed outlook. 5

20. Imagine Kisa Gotami becomes a teacher of others who are bereaved. Write her speech. 5

OR

'Education is not telling but showing.' Discuss in the light of the Buddha's method. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks